

CeylonPick

Marketing Plan — Year 1

Creators · Vendors · Channels · Content · Occasion calendar · Launch · Retention · Budget · Measurement

Version v1.0 · 5 September 2026 · Status: Baseline (year-1 operating plan)

Version History

Version	Date	Author	Summary of changes
v1.0	5 September 2026	Founder (with AI-assisted drafting)	Initial baseline: objectives, audiences, positioning, creator programme, vendor acquisition, channel plan, content system, 12-month calendar, launch plan, retention, budget, measurement.
v1.1	—	—	(reserved) Post day-90 review: replace assumptions with measured CAC, conversion and RTO by creator tier.

Operating principle

CeylonPick does not buy attention; it equips creators to sell. Every rupee of marketing goes to product seeding, content, and the trust signals that make a creator's recommendation convert. Paid media is used only to amplify creator content that has already converted organically. The plan is deliberately narrow in months 1–3 (one niche, one province, twenty creators) and widens only when the day-90 gate is passed.

Companion documents: *Feasibility Study*, *Project Plan v1.0*, *Technical Architecture v1.0*.

1. Objectives and Targets

Marketing exists to move four numbers. Everything in this plan traces back to one of them.

Objective	Day 90	Month 6	Month 12	Owner metric
Delivered orders / month	150	350	700	Weekly delivered count
Active paid creators (earned a payout in last 30d)	8	30	80	Payout run report
Repeat-purchase rate (buyers with 2+ delivered orders)	10%	15%	25%	Buyer cohort table
Blended cost per delivered order (marketing spend ÷ delivered)	≤ LKR 300	≤ LKR 150	≤ LKR 80	Monthly budget ÷ orders
Verified vendors listed	20	50	100	Vendor table
Creator-attributed share of orders	≥ 60%	≥ 55%	≥ 50%	Attribution report

Secondary: WhatsApp broadcast list of 1,500 opted-in buyers by month 12; 50 corporate gifting conversations by month 8; 500 organic search visits/month to gift-guide pages by month 12.

2. Audiences

2.1 Buyers (demand)

Persona	Who	Trigger to buy	What convinces them	Payment habit
The Gifter (primary)	25–40, urban Western Province, salaried, gifts for family/colleagues 6–10 times a year	Occasion + a creator's recommendation	Verified local maker, unboxing quality, delivery date promise	Prepaid if gifting to someone else; COD otherwise
The Conscious Local	28–45, prefers Sri Lankan-made, shops at Good Market / small brands on Instagram	Discovering a maker's story	Provenance, ingredients, founder story, fair pricing	Mixed; will prepay a brand they trust
The Young Follower	18–26, TikTok/Instagram heavy, budget LKR 1,000–3,000	Creator they follow posts a pick	Creator endorsement, code discount, fast delivery	COD, strongly
The Corporate Buyer (M5+)	HR/admin/marketing at SMEs and mid-size firms	Festive season, staff appreciation, client gifts	Catalogue PDF, invoice, bulk pricing, branded card	Bank transfer / invoice

2.2 Creators (distribution)

Tier	Followers	Count target (M1 / M6 / M12)	Offer	What they want
Founding creators	5K–50K, Sinhala/Tamil lifestyle, food, home, student, couple content	20 / 30 / 30	Product seeding + 15–20% commission + name on 'Founding Creators' page + first access to campaigns	To be treated as partners; reliable payment; a link that works
Growth creators	2K–30K, niche-specific (Ayurveda, home décor, parenting, tea)	0 / 20 / 50	Commission 10–20%; seeding on application; Campaign Board access	Easy way to monetise without brand deals
Nano ambassadors	500–5K, engaged local audiences (university, workplace, town)	0 / 0 / 30+	Commission + code; no seeding; leaderboard bonus	Pocket money; recognition
Explicitly not targeted	200K+ celebrities and macro influencers	—	—	Flat fees CeylonPick cannot afford; weak conversion for unknown brands

2.3 Vendors (supply)

Small Sri Lankan makers already selling on Facebook/Instagram/WhatsApp with 50–70% gross margins, 300–20,000 followers, and no distribution beyond their own page: tea and spice micro-brands, kithul/honey/jaggery producers, natural soap and balm makers, small-batch snack producers (niche 1); engravers, printers, embroiderers, illustrators (niche 2); Ayurveda-based skincare and haircare brands with product registration (niche 3).

3. Positioning and Messaging

Audience	Core message	Proof points	Tagline candidates
Buyers	Real Sri Lankan makers, verified by people you can name, recommended by people you follow.	Verified badge · vendor story and photo · founder's name on site · creator banner · packing photo on request	'Picked for you, made in Sri Lanka' · 'Verified makers. Trusted picks.'
Creators	Earn from every recommendation — your own storefront, your own code, paid twice a month, every time.	Published payout calendar · public payout log · founding creators page · live dashboard	'Your picks. Your page. Your payout.'
Vendors	Stop competing with imports on Daraz. Be discovered by creators who sell for you.	Curated shelf of ≤50 SKUs per niche · creator distribution · weekly payout · packing-photo dispute protection	'Made here. Sold by people who care.'
Corporate	One invoice, verified local gifts, branded cards, delivered on time.	Catalogue PDF · bulk pricing · named account manager (founder)	'Local gifts your team will actually keep.'

Voice: warm, specific, never salesy. Name the maker, the district, the ingredient. Avoid 'best', 'cheapest', 'huge sale'. Sinhala and Tamil copy is written natively, not translated from English.

4. Creator Programme (the engine)

4.1 Recruitment funnel — month 1

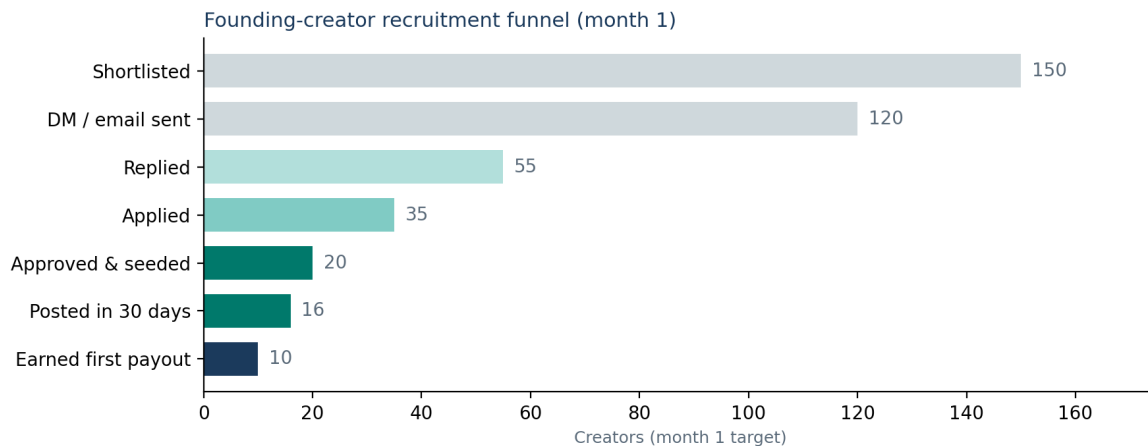


Figure 1 — Recruitment funnel. Numbers are month-1 targets; replace with actuals in v1.1.

Step	How	Tooling	Time
Shortlist 150	Search TikTok/Instagram hashtags (#srilankanfood, #colombolife, #homedecorlk, #couplegoalssl, #uni life), Sinhala/Tamil lifestyle content 5K–50K followers, engagement > 3%; note niche and language	Google Sheet: handle, platform, followers, niche, language, engagement, contact	Week 1, 6–8 hours
Personal outreach 120	DM or email, personalised (name a specific video). Offer: founding creator, free products, 15–20% commission, storefront page, paid twice monthly	Template with 3 variants; 20 per day	Week 1–2
Onboarding call 35	15-minute WhatsApp call: explain payout calendar, RTO rule, storefront; agree first product	Calendar link; onboarding checklist	Week 2–3
Seed 20	Deliver 2–3 products each (vendor-donated + CeylonPick-funded), handwritten note, brief	Seeding tracker; courier	Week 3–4
Activate	First post within 14 days of receiving product; CeylonPick reshares; founder comments personally	Content calendar; WhatsApp founders' group	Week 4–6

4.2 Programme rules (published on the Earn page)

- Commission 10–20% of product price, set per product by the vendor; shown on every product in the creator dashboard.
- Earned when an order reaches **delivered + 7 days** with no dispute. Cancelled, unconfirmed and returned orders earn nothing.
- Paid on the **1st and 16th** of every month by bank transfer, minimum LKR 2,000 per payout; smaller balances roll forward.
- Attribution: 30-day link cookie, last click wins; a code typed at checkout overrides the cookie.
- Return rate above 30% on your attributed orders (with 10+ orders) pauses your account for review; above 40% closes it.
- No fake discounts, no misleading claims about ingredients or origin, disclose #ad/#commission per platform norms.
- Founding creators: name and handle on the Founding Creators page for as long as the platform exists.

4.3 Keeping creators active

Mechanism	Cadence	Cost
Weekly brief in the founders' WhatsApp group: one product, its story, three hook ideas, current commission	Every Wednesday	Time
Founder reshares every creator post on CeylonPick channels and comments personally	Daily	Time

Mechanism	Cadence	Cost
Monthly leaderboard: top 3 by delivered orders get a bonus (LKR 2,000 / 1,000 / 500) and a feature post	Monthly	LKR 3,500
Quarterly 'creator drop': one creator co-curates a limited hamper with a vendor, named after them	Quarterly from M4	Product cost shared with vendor
Public payout log (aggregate) and 'paid on time' streak counter on the Earn page	Fortnightly	Time
Campaign Board (v2): vendors post seeded campaigns; creators apply	From M4 (manual), M6 (in-app)	Vendor-funded seeding

5. Vendor Acquisition

Source	Approach	Target (M1 / M6 / M12)
Good Market (Colombo) and weekend craft/food markets	Visit, buy, talk, follow up on WhatsApp with a one-page pitch and the verification checklist	8 / 15 / 25
Instagram/Facebook small brands (search #madeinsrilanka #srilankanbrand #handmadesl)	Personal DM referencing a product; offer curated shelf + creator distribution + weekly payouts	8 / 20 / 40
Regional producers (tea estates' small brands, Matale spices, Kandy kithul, Galle/Ambalangoda crafts)	Founder trips (2 per quarter) combined with vendor-story video shoots	2 / 8 / 15
Referrals from existing vendors	LKR 2,000 credit against commission for each verified referral that ships 10 orders	2 / 7 / 20

Vendor pitch (30 seconds): *'On Daraz you are one of 200 soaps next to imports at a third of your price. On CeylonPick you are one of 40 verified makers, and 20 creators are looking for exactly your product to recommend. You set the creator commission; we take 6%; you are paid every Friday.'*

Vendor content asset: every verified vendor gets a 45–60 second story video shot by the founder (phone + LKR 3,000 mic). It is the vendor's to reuse, and CeylonPick's best-converting content.

6. Channel Plan by Phase

Channel	M1–3 (Test)	M4–6 (Fix & widen)	M7–12 (Scale)	Role
Creator content (TikTok, Instagram Reels, YouTube Shorts)	20 founding creators, ≥ 1 post/week each	40–50 creators; Campaign Board	80–100 creators; leaderboard; drops	Primary acquisition (target ≥ 55% of orders)
CeylonPick own accounts (IG, TikTok, FB)	Vendor stories, reshares, behind-the-scenes; 4 posts/week	Add gift guides, packing videos	Add corporate case posts	Trust and proof, not acquisition
WhatsApp (broadcast list + support)	Opt-in on every order; status messages	Occasion reminders; creator picks (1/week max)	Referral prompts; VIP early access	Retention (target 25% repeat)
Search / SEO	Product pages indexed; basic titles	Gift-guide pages for Avurudu, Vesak	Blog: 2 guides/month; vendor stories	Compounding organic (500 visits/mo by M12)
Paid social	None	LKR 5–6K/month boosting creator videos that converted organically	LKR 6–10K/month; retarget site visitors with creator content	Amplification only
Corporate outreach (email + LinkedIn + visits)	None	50 warm contacts; catalogue PDF	Year-end campaign; 10 accounts	High AOV, always prepaid
Offline / events	Good Market stall once (vendor recruiting + sampling)	1 pop-up with 5 vendors + 5 creators	Festive pop-up	Content + trust; break-even on sales
PR	None	1 story pitch to Daily FT / Roar / Readme about the creator model	Founder interviews; creator earnings story	Credibility for vendors and corporates

12-month campaign calendar (amber = occasion-driven, navy = niche/channel launch, grey = always-on)

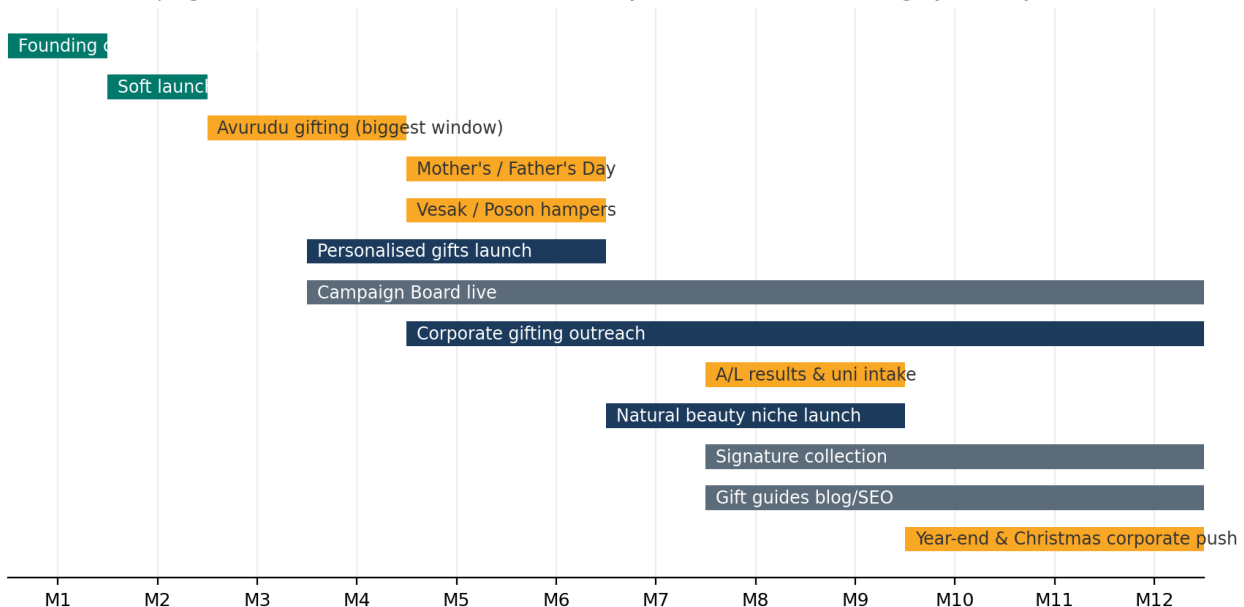


Figure 2 — Campaign calendar. Sri Lankan & Tamil New Year is the single biggest gifting window and lands inside the test phase — plan for it from week 1.

7. Content System

7.1 Pillars (all channels)

Pillar	Share	Examples	Purpose
Maker stories	30%	'Meet Nimali, who makes kithul treacle in Matale' · ingredient close-ups · workshop tours	Trust, differentiation
Creator picks	30%	Reshared creator videos · 'Three gifts under LKR 3,000 picked by @name'	Conversion
Occasion guides	20%	Avurudu hamper guide · Vesak gift ideas · A/L results gifts	Timely demand capture
Proof & process	15%	Packing videos · unboxings · payout-day posts · 'delivered in 26 hours' screenshots	Reduce COD hesitation
Community	5%	Founding creators page · leaderboard · thank-you posts	Retention of creators

7.2 Weekly rhythm (founder, ~6 hours/week)

Day	Action
Monday	Review last week's top-converting creator video; decide the week's featured product
Tuesday	Shoot or edit one maker story (batch 3–4 per vendor visit)
Wednesday	Send creator brief (product, story, 3 hooks, commission, occasion angle); post maker story
Thursday	Reshare creator posts; reply to every comment; WhatsApp broadcast if an occasion is within 3 weeks
Friday	Payout day post ('LKR X paid to N creators today'); packing/proof video
Weekend	Good Market / vendor visits (fortnightly); schedule next week's posts

7.3 Creator brief template

PRODUCT : <name> by <vendor>, LKR <price>, commission <x>% (= LKR <y> per delivered order)
 WHY IT SELLS : <one true, specific sentence – ingredient, origin, story>
 OCCASION : <Avurudu / birthday / self-care Sunday / exam gift>
 3 HOOKS : 1) "I stopped buying imported <thing> when I found this in <district>"
 2) "Gift under LKR 3,000 that doesn't look like it" 3) "What LKR <price> gets you from a real maker"
 MUST SHOW : product in hand, verified badge screenshot or site, your code on screen for 3+ seconds
 MUST NOT : fake discounts, medical claims, 'best in Sri Lanka'
 LINK / CODE : ceylonpick.lk/@<handle> code <HANDLE10>
 DEADLINE : post by <date>; tag @ceylonpick; send us the link for reshare

8. Occasion Calendar and Campaign Playbook

Window	Dates (approx.)	Campaign	Niche fit	Lead time	Notes
Valentine's	1–14 Feb	'Made with love, made here'	Personalised, hampers	4 weeks	Prepaid-heavy; couple creators
Sinhala & Tamil New Year	1–13 Apr	'Avurudu Hamper Drop'	Hampers, sweets, tea	6 weeks	Biggest window of the year; corporate + family; courier cut-off 9 Apr
Vesak / Poson	May / Jun	'Gifts of quiet'	Tea, incense-free naturals, treats for dansal hosts	3 weeks	Low-key tone; avoid hard selling
Mother's / Father's Day	May / Jun	'For the one who made you'	Personalised, beauty, hampers	3 weeks	Creator stories about parents
A/L results & university intake	Aug–Sep (varies)	'You did it' gifts	Personalised, small hampers	2 weeks after date announced	Student creators; nano ambassadors
Christmas & year-end	15 Nov–20 Dec	'Local gifts your team will keep' (corporate) · 'Under the tree, made here' (consumer)	All niches; corporate hampers	8 weeks; corporate outreach from Sep	Courier cut-off 18 Dec; largest AOV
Always-on	—	Birthdays, housewarming, self-care	All	—	Evergreen gift-guide pages

Playbook per occasion (T-minus schedule)

- T-6 weeks: pick 10–15 SKUs, confirm vendor stock and lead times, set cut-off date, design the landing page.
- T-4 weeks: brief creators; seed occasion-specific product; corporate email wave (from M5).
- T-3 weeks: landing page live; WhatsApp broadcast #1 (soft); own-channel guide posts begin.
- T-2 weeks: creator posts peak; small boost on the two best-performing videos.
- T-1 week: 'order by' reminder; WhatsApp broadcast #2; stock check daily.
- T+1 week: thank-you posts, UGC collection, post-mortem: orders, RTO, best creator, best SKU — feeds v1.1 of this plan.

9. Launch Plan (Weeks 5–10 of the build)

Stage	When	What happens	Success signal
Friends & founders test	Build week 6–7	30 real orders from friends, creators and vendors themselves; both COD and prepaid; deliberately trigger one RTO and one dispute	Every state transition exercised; ledger reconciles
Soft launch (Western Province)	Build week 8 → +2 weeks	Site live; no announcement; 20 creators post over 14 days (staggered, not all on day one); founder handles every order personally	≥ 60 delivered orders; RTO ≤ 25%; 5 creators with ≥ 3 delivered orders
Public launch	Week 10	Founding Creators page live; 'How CeylonPick works' video; PR pitch; vendor story series begins; WhatsApp list opened	≥ 100 orders in launch fortnight; first payout run completed and posted publicly
Avurudu campaign	M3–4	First occasion campaign at full effort — this doubles as the day-90 gate	Day-90 KPIs met (150 delivered/month, RTO ≤ 25%, 8 paid creators)

Do not launch everything on one day. A staggered creator rollout produces two weeks of steady orders (which the founder can fulfil well) instead of one spike (which creates the first bad reviews).

10. Retention and Referral

Mechanism	Detail	Target effect
Thank-you card in every parcel	Handwritten first name, maker's name, creator's code for LKR 200 off next order, WhatsApp number	Repeat rate; creator loyalty
WhatsApp broadcast list	Opt-in at checkout; ≤ 1 message/week; occasion reminders and one creator pick	25% repeat by M12; near-zero cost
Buyer referral	Refer a friend → LKR 300 off for both after the friend's first delivered order (v2 code)	Cheapest acquisition channel from M6
Reorder in one tap	Buyer account shows past orders with 'Order again'	Consumables (tea, spices, soap) repeat
Post-delivery message	T+2 days: 'How was it?' with a 1-tap rating; unhappy → founder calls	Catch problems before public reviews
Occasion memory (v2)	Buyer can save a date (mother's birthday) → reminder 3 weeks before	Gifting repeat

11. Marketing Budget

Of the LKR 60,000 monthly fund, roughly LKR 33,000–48,000 is marketing in the sense of this plan; the rest is tools, part-time ops and reserve (see Project Plan). Total marketing spend for the year ≈ LKR 463,000.

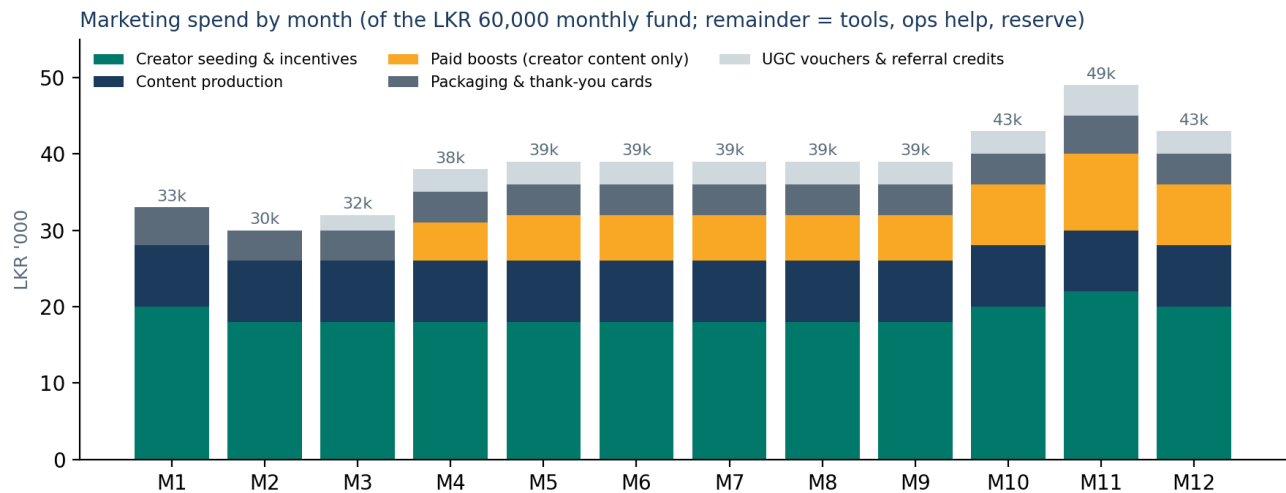


Figure 3 — Marketing spend by month. Seeding is the largest and most stable line; paid boosts start only after organic conversion is proven.

Line	Year total (LKR)	Rule
Creator seeding & incentives (products, leaderboard bonuses)	≈ 226,000	Vendors co-fund seeding from M4; never cash for posts
Content production (photography, props, mic, editing)	≈ 96,000	Founder shoots; pay only for a monthly editor if hours run out
Paid boosts	≈ 61,000	Only creator videos with proven organic conversion; stop any boost with cost/order > LKR 400
Packaging & thank-you cards	≈ 50,000	Part of the product experience, counted as marketing
UGC vouchers & referral credits	≈ 30,000	Paid only against delivered orders
Not funded	0	Influencer flat fees, agency retainers, brand awareness ads, giveaways with no attribution

12. Measurement

12.1 Funnel and weekly review

Stage	Metric	Source	Healthy (M6)
Reach	Creator posts/week; views	Creator self-report + platform links	≥ 40 posts/week
Traffic	Sessions by creator code / UTM	Attribution clicks table; Plausible or GA4	≥ 2,500 sessions/week
Conversion	Sessions → placed orders	Orders / sessions	1.5–3%
Confirmation	Placed → confirmed (OTP / payment)	State history	≥ 80%
Delivery	Confirmed → delivered (1 – RTO)	State history	≥ 80% (RTO ≤ 20%)
Revenue	Delivered AOV; platform commission	Ledger	AOV ≥ LKR 2,800
Retention	Repeat rate 60-day; WhatsApp opt-in rate	Buyer cohorts	15%; 60%
Creator health	Active paid creators; median earnings; RTO by creator	Payout report; creator stats	30 paid; median ≥ LKR 4,000

12.2 Conventions

- Every creator link carries the creator code; every own-channel link carries utm_source (instagram/tiktok/whatsapp/blog), utm_campaign (avurudu26, vesak26 ...).
- Weekly marketing review is 30 minutes on Monday from the Admin dashboard plus one sheet: creator × posts × orders × RTO × earnings.
- Monthly: rank SKUs by delivered orders and by RTO; drop the bottom 10% of SKUs and the worst-RTO creators; double seeding on the top 5 creators.
- Every occasion campaign ends with a one-page post-mortem that becomes a change in the next version of this plan.

13. Marketing Risks and Responses

Risk	Signal	Response
Creators post once and go quiet	< 50% of seeded creators post in 30 days	Fix the brief and the product, not the creator; call each personally; replace 5 lowest with new recruits
Traffic but no orders	Sessions up, conversion < 1%	Check price vs comparable, shipping fee visibility, page speed; test COD trust copy
Orders but high RTO	RTO > 25% on a creator or SKU	Pause creator/SKU; tighten OTP script; lower COD cap for that category
One niche dominates, others dead	> 85% of orders from one niche by M6	Delay the third niche; deepen the winner (more SKUs, more creators)
Copycat platform launches	Another 'local marketplace' appears	Ignore; publish payout streak and creator earnings; speed of payment is the moat
Founder time exhausted	Content rhythm slips 2 weeks in a row	Hire the part-time editor/ops from the M4 budget line earlier; cut own-channel posting to 2/week

End of document — v1.0